Ann-Kareen Gedeus

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EDUCATION

Cornell University Aug 2024 – present | New York, NY
PhD, Information Science
Advisor: Angelique Taylor
GPA: 4.057

University of Florida Aug 2020 – May 2024 | Gainesville, FL
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
GPA: 3.7/4.0

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Artificial Intelligence, Generative AI, Multimodal Interactions, Human-AI Interaction, Machine Learning and Natural Language Processing, and Ethics in mental health technologies

SKILLS

Python, C++, C, C#, Java, Javascript, Go, SQL, MATLAB, Unity, ReadyPlayerMe, FER+, Machine Learning, Prompt Engineering, Co-design/Participatory Studies

PUBLICATIONS

Gedeus, A., Wagener, N., Bai, Y., Felver, J., Difede, J., Yoon, S., Taylor, A. (2026) "Talk to Me Kindly: Designing AI Companions to Foster Positive Self-Talk in Young Adults" ACM Designing Interactive Systems (DIS 2026) [Submitted]

Gedeus, A., Li, Y., Wang, A., Taylor, A. (2026) "The Great Marketing Scheme: How AI "Therapy" Chatbots are tricking users" AAAI/ACM Artificial Intelligence, Ethics, and Society (AIES 2026) [Planned Submission]

Gedeus, A., Good, J., Wagener, N., Taylor, A. "Designing AI Companions Non-Verbal Communication For Positive Self-Talk" ACM International Conference on Multimodal Interaction (ICMI 2026) [Planned Submission]

RESEARCH TALKS

Gedeus A., "Talk to Me Kindly: Designing AI Companions to Foster Positive Self-Talk in Young Adults". *Cornell Tech Builders and Disruptors in the AI Era,* New York, New York. December 2025

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Gedeus A., Bai Y., Taylor A., Yoon S., "Designing AI-Avatars to support young adults in emotion regulation with positive self-talk". *Cornell University, Ithaca, NY*. December 2024.

Gedeus A., Bai Y., Taylor A., Yoon S., " "Designing AI-Avatars to support young adults in emotion regulation with positive self-talk". *Cornell Tech, NY, NY*. June 2025.

Arce T., **Gedeus A.**, "A Comparison of Augmented Reality Corsi-Block-Tapping Tests To Their Physical Counterparts". *National Society of Black Engineers 50th Annual National Convention,* Atlanta, Georgia. March 2024.

Arce T., **Gedeus A.**, "A Comparison of Augmented Reality Corsi-Block-Tapping Tests To Their Physical Counterparts". *University of Florida Undergraduate Research Symposium,* Gainesville, Florida. April 2024.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Artificial Intelligence and Robotics Lab, Cornell Aug 2025 – Present
PhD Student, Dr. Angelique Taylor, Dr. Angelina Wang
Project Name: The Great Marketing Scheme: How AI "Therapy" Chatbots are tricking users
- Conducted a comparative design and content audit of marketing materials and legal disclosures across commercial AI mental health chatbots.
- Coded promotional claims and formal disclaimers to identify representational dark patterns, risks of therapeutic misconception, and ethical concerns related to user vulnerability and informed consent.
- Applied frameworks from deceptive design, sociotechnical systems to examine how language, framing, and placement shape user trust, expectations, and perceived clinical authority.
- Analyzed implications for ethical design, accountability, and governance of AI mental health systems.
- First author of a manuscript documenting the methods, findings, and ethical implications of unregulated commercial AI mental health chatbots

Artificial Intelligence and Robotics Lab, Cornell University Aug 2024 – Present
PhD Student, Dr. Angelique Taylor
Project Name: Talk to Me Kindly: Designing AI Companions to Foster Positive Self-Talk in Young Adults
- Designed and conducted a qualitative study (11 licensed therapists, 4 AI experts) to investigate how positive self-talk (PST) can be supported in young adults through non-clinical AI systems
- Developed the *Human-AI Self-Talk Framework (HAIST)* to translate therapeutic strategies into interaction design principles for AI companions
- Performed qualitative coding and thematic analysis to identify insights related to young adults
- First author of a manuscript documenting methods, findings, and implications for human-AI interaction in mental health contexts

Artificial Intelligence and Robotics Lab, Cornell University Aug 2024 – Present
PhD Student, Dr. Angelique Taylor
Project Name: Designing AI Companions Non-Verbal Communication For Positive Self-Talk
- Investigated how backchanneling and behavioral mimicry in Ready Player Me avatars affect rapport with young adults engaging in self-talk.
- Implemented emotion detection pipelines using FER+ and deep convolutional neural networks to infer users' affect from facial expressions in real time.
- Integrated affect signals into a Unity-based avatar system to trigger adaptive backchanneling and mimicry behaviors.
- First author of a manuscript documenting methods, findings, and design implications for how nonverbal communication can be used to build rapport with young adults in self-talk contexts.

SoundPad Lab, University of Florida Aug 2022 – Apr 2024
Undergraduate Research Assistant, Dr. Kyla McMullen
- Designed an Augmented Reality (AR) Corsi Block-Tapping Test (CBT) to understand spatial memory in virtual environments
- Collected data on subject performance in AR CBTs, Physical CBTs, Physical Walking CBTs, and AR Walking CBTs
- Leveraged knowledge of Microsoft Mixed Reality Toolkit (MRTK) to implement CBTs and understand AR aspects of spatial memory
- Conducted quantitative analysis of subject CBT data using computational methods for hypothesis testing with ANOVAS
- Results demonstrated that there were no significant differences in subject performance

Computing for Social Good Lab, University of Florida Aug 2021 – May 2022
Undergraduate Research Assistant, Dr. Juan Gilbert
- Conducted User Experience (UI/UX) and Internet of Things (IoT) research on Health Applications that improve the health and wellness of people in rural areas
- Implemented a functional prototype of a Health IoT system that remotely monitors a user's heart rate and controls an LED using an Arduino, the Blynk Cloud Platform, and ReactJS

- Created a Health IoT system that maximizes interoperability and data accessibility
- Developed a web dashboard capable of streaming patient biometrics in real-time over a Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) connection instead of Wi-Fi
- Created a notification system to alert the user of 3 main features
- Tested Interoperability using ESP32 and Polar Heart Rate Sensor

Computing for Social Good Lab, University of Florida Jan 2021 – May 2021

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Dr. Juan Gilbert

- Searched and read papers on Google Scholar for security vulnerabilities in DVDs
- Created a report on DVD security within voting machines
- Researched literature on technologies used for voting
- Read relevant literature on voter fraud and prevention

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

F5 Networks May 2024 – Aug 2024 | Seattle, WA

Software Engineering Intern

- Integrated Bazel build system into 15 features in one of BIG-IP repositories
- Changed the build schema of each feature from Go Builds to Bazel builds, by modifying existing docker files and using Gazelle BUILD.bazel files
- Cut the build time of the entire repository by more than half with Bazel integration

F5 Networks May 2023 – Aug 2023 | Seattle, WA

Software Engineering Intern

- Integrated into the NGINX Amplify team, and worked on tasks on the Jira backlog
- Created a developer-side login system using Docker and Golang allowing for faster access to developer tools
- Developed public-facing interactive features to display NGINX directive information
- Developed a uniform styling for tags across the Amplify webpage

Microsoft & Cyborg Mobile Jun 2022 – Aug 2022 | Remote

New Technologist Intern

- Developed an app utilizing ReactJs, that gamifies financial literacy for young adults
- Designed engineering specs, conducted user interviews, prototyped, and scoped out the team project
- Worked on backend features that calculate account balances and update account numbers after button click using React hooks and props
- Displayed messages/alerts during certain states using React Hooks

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer, ACM CHI conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, CHI 2026

Reviewer, ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction, HRI 2026

Reviewer, ACM Designing Interactive Systems, DIS 2026

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Graduate Research Fellow 2024 – present

National Science Foundation

- 1 of 2,037 selected from 14,106

Graduate School Dean's Scholar 2024 – present

Cornell University, Cornell Tech

McNair Scholar 2023 – 2024

University of Florida, Ronald E. McNair
Post-Baccalaureate Achievement Program

University Scholar 2023 – 2024

University of Florida Center for Undergraduate Research
University Scholars Program

TEACHING & MENTORING

Peer Mentor Aug 2022 – May 2024
University of Florida, National Society of Black Engineers
- Guide 3 black computer science students in their course planning and navigating their engineering classes at a PWI
- Help the students find research opportunities and connect them to research advisors

Teaching Assistant, Head TA Aug 2022 – Dec 2023
University of Florida, CEN3031 - Intro to Software Engineering
- Lead discussion section with 25-30 students every week for Intro to Software Engineering
- Operate Office hours and manage Slack to answer student questions and help with project code
- Scored over student presentations, projects, and daily scrums
- Managing 70+ students' grades and questions as head TA

Co-Curriculum Developer Jan 2023 – May 2023
University of Florida, CIS4930 - FullStack Internet of Things
- Worked on creating a WebSocket chat application project specification for the course
- Collaborated with 3 undergraduates on the project
- Leveraged concepts and theories from IoT research to create project specification

First-Generation Peer Mentor Sep 2021 – May 2023
University of Florida, Machen Florida Opportunity Scholars
- Provided academic and emotional support to 8 First-Generation freshmen
- Meet with mentees every month and discuss academic progress, club involvement, and social life
- Discuss finances and managing MFOS scholarship money

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Secretary May 2023 – May 2024
University of Florida, National Society of Black Engineers
- Lead communication zone, consisting of 4 members
- Assign tasks to zone members and divide the workload
- Manage room bookings, bi-weekly newsletter, and social media

Publications Chair Aug 2022 – May 2023
University of Florida, National Society of Black Engineers
- Create event flyers for social media posts and meetings
- Manage social media and inform members of upcoming events

VOLUNTEER

Cornell Tech, Older Adults Technology Feb 2025
Volunteer
- Aid older adults in understanding their technology
- Help troubleshoot technological issues on their devices

Queens Tech Fair Jan 2025
Volunteer
- Community event engaging Queens borough residents in Tech fields
- Demonstrate and present lab research projects

LANGUAGES

Haitian Kreyol — *Native Speaker* | **French** — *Proficient in Speaking & Writing*